

Critical Reflection on Deconstruction as of Wednesday, 24 August 2022.

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As a fan of deconstruction, I am not particularly fond of the movement in architecture.

It cannot be denied that it truly is a remarkable development to a modernist and capitalist regime, but it lends itself to being a part of a polarised narrative.

The ideology behind deconstruction is to constantly evoke change and evolution through the subversion of norm and traditional order.

The radical approach is basically a direct opposition to the convention, positioning itself as a counter argument.

This may have been exceptionally relevant at its time and proven context, but arguably has not aged well.

What must be held close to heart is the founding sentiment and not the aesthetic execution of the movement.

dovey makes the most interesting points pertaining to the relationships between practical programming, post-structuralism and deconstructive thought.

In the commentary on “structuration, habits and gaze,” Dovey describes power and built form as an enabler or constrictor of systems; which is articulated by spatial programming and architectural language.

I am most interested in the relationship between habit and habitat, and how taxonomic strategies are integrated with the human cognitive mapping process.

The principles of spatial analysis reveal much about access, visibility and power; and how meaning can be subverted in favour of different systems depending on the applied context.

This text is profoundly relevant to the practical applications of deconstruction.

On the other hand, i cannot say i have ever understood the full extent of tschumi’s parc de la villette, and i suppose that may be part of the point of the intervention.

the project aims to explore “concepts of superimposition and dissociation” by using the following elements:

disjunction and culture, dis-structuring, order, strategies of disjunction, limits, notation.

the methodology is proposed is of:

1. rejecting synthesis and harmony
2. rejecting tradition/juxtapose elements that can be contrasted and similarly analyzed and
3. focusing on fragmentation, and assembling elements that provoke dissociation.

In summarising the above, there is not much i disagree with, other than the principle of having a methodology of extremes.

I am critical of the thought of “rejection” as it still yields a response to the “other.”

I certainly appreciate the priority of evocative thought over functional meaning, but it is clear that buildings or interventions following this principle treat themselves more like an artwork without context, according to its principles.

This form of expressionist statement was certainly revolutionary, but also lends itself to an extreme approach to architecture that defeats the purpose of thinking with a deconstruction based philosophy.

It is my opinion that architecture should remain critical without being easily swayed to a single manifesto. The truest spirit of the philosophy is that power should not be given to any extreme, and should instead provoke and perpetuate identity as that which sits in the middle of a spectrum, challenging the tension between binaries.